AI Marketing Trend Radar: install and customise

Nov 9, 2026 · @Andy

The radar scans the last 7 days of news and conversation on your topic, ranks what matters to your audience, and hands you post angles in chat plus a branded page and PDF for your team. You choose the topic, the audience and the branding, so you end up with your own version. It needs no paid tools, accounts or API keys.

Getting started

1. **Upload the skill.** In Claude, turn on file creation (Settings, then Capabilities, then *Create and edit files*). Then click *Customize* in the sidebar, open the *Skills* tab, click *+ Add* and choose *Upload skill*. Upload `ai-marketing-trend-radar.zip` without unzipping it, then open it from your list and check the toggle next to *Try in chat* is on. In Claude Code, unzip it into `~/.claude/skills/`.
2. **Optional: make a design system.** If you want the report in your brand, create a Claude design system first (colours, fonts, and your logo or photo in its assets). Without one the report uses a clean neutral look.
3. **Run setup.** Type `/ai-marketing-trend-radar set up the radar`. Claude asks for your topic, audience, region and which design system to use. It then writes the search queries and the lists of companies, trade press and newsletters to watch, shows you a branded preview, and saves your settings into the skill.
4. **Run it weekly.** Type `/ai-marketing-trend-radar` whenever you want this week's report.

Setup takes about five minutes. You can rerun it any time to change the topic or the branding.

Running it

Type `/ai-marketing-trend-radar`, or ask in plain words. What you add after it decides the mode.

What you type	Mode	What happens
`/ai-marketing-trend-radar` or "what's trending this week"	Radar (default)	Scans your saved queries across all sources for your saved topic, ranks 5–8 trends
`/ai-marketing-trend-radar AI in healthcare`	Focused	Researches that topic for this run only, through your audience's lens, ranks 3–5 trends
`/ai-marketing-trend-radar Claude vs ChatGPT for marketers`	Comparison	Runs both sides plus the head-to-head, gives a verdict and content angles
`/ai-marketing-trend-radar set up the radar`	Setup	Asks for topic, audience, region and design system, previews the branding, saves your settings

`/ai-marketing-trend-radar brand it with my Acme design system`	Radar, one-off branding	Uses that design system for this run without changing your saved settings

The window is always the last 7 days, worked out from today's date. A run takes a few minutes because six research agents search in parallel before anything is written.

Where it looks

Six sources, all read with Claude's own web search and fetch, plus the free Hacker News API.

Source	What it brings
Hacker News	Early warning on tools and platform changes, with points and comments
Trade press	The publications on your `trade_press` list, with named voices
Web	News and analysis from beyond your trade press list, plus any X post or YouTube video it can date inside the week
Launches	Announcements from the companies on your `companies` list, read from the company's own post
Research and data	New surveys, reports and benchmarks, with the numbers exactly as published
Newsletters	Substack, Beehiiv and the newsletters on your list: where practitioners argue

What you get

Every run produces three outputs from the same data file, so they always match.

Output	Where it appears	Use it for
Full report	In the chat	Reading and copying hooks straight into drafts
Shareable page	A private link in your artifacts, updated at the same link on reruns in that chat	Sending to the team once you share it from its Share menu
A4 PDF	A file in the chat	Emailing, printing or dropping into Slack

Each trend carries:

- What happened and why your audience should care
- The conversation, with verbatim quotes and who said them
- Three content angles (hot take, practical, contrarian), each with a suggested format
- How crowded the topic already is, and how long it stays fresh

The page and PDF add a stat tile row, the Trend Score ranking chart, a matrix of which sources each trend showed up in, and a chart of the week. They close with rising signals, a loud-but-skip list, the content plan table and sources.

After the report, ask for a LinkedIn post, a carousel, a newsletter section or a deeper look at any trend. Say what to change ("drop trend 5", "reword that hook") and it rebuilds the page and PDF together.

How trends are scored

The Trend Score (0–100) is a weighted sum of four parts, and the circle on each trend card shows it.

Part	Weight	Scores high when
Signal	35%	The top items are recent, relevant and from strong sources, and the trend appears in several sources (+10 for two, +20 for three or more)
Audience relevance	30%	It changes your audience's job this quarter (100); useful context scores 60, tangential 30
Content potential	25%	There is live debate (+30), a hard data point (+25), an angle not yet widely covered (+25), a practical hook (+20)
Momentum	10%	Most items are from the last 3 days (100); spread evenly (50); peaked early (20)

Each item is scored on relevance and recency. Hacker News items add their points and comments; everything else adds a source weight, highest for primary sources (the company's own announcement, the original research) and established trade press. Items carrying a hard number get a small bonus.

Items only count if they're dated inside the window. Newer items weigh more: 0–1 days scores 100, 2–3 days 85, 4–5 days 70, 6–7 days 55.

A trend needs at least two sources to rank. A story from one source goes under rising signals.

What it needs

Needs	Why	Without it
Create and edit files on (Settings, then Capabilities)	Builds the page and renders the PDF	You get the chat report only
Your own Claude design system (optional)	Brands the page and PDF with your colours, fonts, logo or photo	Builds in the neutral theme; you can also give brand colours, fonts and a logo in chat instead
Python, Playwright with Chromium, npm	Builds the page and renders the PDF with your fonts embedded	Available by default in cloud sessions; the skill installs what's missing

No accounts, scrapers or API keys. Running it costs nothing beyond your Claude plan.

Make it yours: topic and audience

Your topic and audience live in a Settings block at the top of the skill, and setup fills it in for you. Every run reads them, so the research, the relevance test and the angles all follow your choices.

Setting	What it controls	Example
`topic`	What the radar tracks by default	AI in financial services
`audience`, `audience_detail`	Who the content is for; drives "why it matters" and the angles	Compliance leaders at UK banks
`report_name`	The report's name on the page and PDF	FinServ AI Radar
`region`	Stories with this region's angle get flagged	UK
`voice`	How the chat report and hooks sound	Plain and measured, no hype
`queries`, `companies`, `trade_press`, `newsletters`	Where it looks; setup generates these for your topic	Monzo, Revolut; finextra.com

To change one of these for good, run `/ai-marketing-trend-radar set up the radar` again, or ask Claude to change a single setting and save the skill. To change the topic for one run only, add it after the command.

Check that the companies, publications and newsletters setup suggests are ones your audience actually follows. Ask Claude to swap any that aren't. These lists do most of the work, so a good list means a good report.

Brand it with your design system

The report's layout stays the same for everyone; your design system supplies the colours, fonts and brand marks. Claude reads your design system, maps it onto the report and saves that mapping, so every week looks identical.

Which branding a run uses, first match wins:

1. A design system you name in the request ("brand it with my Acme design system"), or choose under *+*, then *Design system*
2. The theme saved in your Settings by setup
3. The design system named in your Settings
4. Your own design systems: your default, or your only one; if you have several, Claude asks which
5. None: the neutral built-in look

Report element	Comes from
Page background, cards, borders	Your surface and border colours

Headlines, body text, labels	Your heading and body fonts and text colours
Accent band, score circles, links	Your primary colour, with darker and lighter steps for the score circles (80+, 70–79, below 70)
Chart colours	Four brand colours that are easy to tell apart
Chart of the week and footer	Your dark or inverse colour
Masthead byline and footer	Your logo, or your photo plus name; a small icon and link on the right, such as a newsletter
Corners, uppercase labels, decorative strip	Your radius tokens and voice rules

Tips for a design system that brands well:

- Put your logo or photo in the design system's assets. If your logo only works on light backgrounds, add a reversed version too, or the footer shows your name in text instead.
- Use Google Fonts families, so the PDF can embed them.
- Describe what each colour is for. Claude maps colours by their descriptions, not just their names.
- Include a dark colour and a text colour that sits on your primary colour.

No design system? Tell Claude your brand colours (hex codes), a headline font, a body font, and attach your logo. It builds the theme from those. The build flags text that's too faint to read or chart colours that look alike, and Claude adjusts the theme before publishing.

Changing things

To change	Do this
Wording, a trend, the plan order in this week's report	Ask in the same chat; the page and PDF rebuild at the same link
The topic for one run	Add it after the command, e.g. `/ai-marketing-trend-radar AI in paid search`
Your default topic, audience, region or voice	Run setup again, or ask Claude to change that setting and save the skill
Queries, companies, trade press or newsletters	Ask Claude to edit them in Settings and save the skill
Branding for one run	Name a design system in the request, or ask for a tweak ("darker accent")
Your saved branding	Run setup again after changing your design system, so the saved theme is re-mapped
Scoring weights	Edit the weights in Step 4 and `WEIGHTS` in the builder script together

Saving works through Claude's skill review card. Where that isn't available, Claude gives you the updated `SKILL.md` to replace your copy with: re-zip the folder and upload it again under Customize, then Skills.

Limits

- **The radar reports only what it finds dated inside the 7-day window,** so a quiet week means a thinner report, not invented filler.
- **It reads published content, not social feeds.** X posts and YouTube videos come in only when web search finds them, with no likes or views, and Reddit and LinkedIn are left out, so it won't tell you what's viral there. It finds what's being written about and argued over in the press, in newsletters and on Hacker News, which is usually where those conversations get picked up.
- **Breadth stands in for engagement.** Only Hacker News returns crowd numbers. For everything else, a trend scores high because several independent sources covered it this week.
- **UK and EU angles depend on the week.** The radar flags them when they appear. Add regional publications to `trade_press` if you want more.
- **Check any number before you post it.** Every figure links back to its source in the report.
- **The page is private until you share it.** Use its Share menu before sending the link to the team. The PDF can go straight out.
- **Check the first branded preview.** Design systems name things differently, so the first mapping is a best reading of yours. Setup shows a preview before saving; ask for fixes then, and they're kept.
- **Topics far from tech get less from Hacker News.** That source stays in but may return little; the other five carry more weight.

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